

US Markets Daily Intelligence Report

Friday, July 24, 2026 | After Market Close (ET)

■ DATA NOTE: Full 252-day historical backfill was unavailable — direct financial data APIs were blocked by the environment proxy policy. SPY close is confirmed from multiple web sources. QQQ July 24 close is an estimate (prior close \$705.35 × Nasdaq-100 −0.90%). 52-week high/low/return figures are confirmed from search results.

1. SPY & QQQ Snapshot

Metric	SPY (S&P 500 ETF)	QQQ (Nasdaq-100 ETF)
Today's Close	\$738.93	\$698.99 *est
Prev Close	\$738.19	\$705.35
Daily % Change	+0.10%	-0.90% *est
52-Wk High	\$760.40	\$748.65
52-Wk Low	\$619.29	\$551.68
1-Year Return	+15.98%	+22.19%
Weekly Return	−0.60%	−2.10%

* QQQ July 24 close estimated; 52-wk stats via confirmed web search. Weekly return from back-to-back weekly loss data (S&P; −0.6%, Nasdaq −2.1%).

2. Today's Key News & Market-Move Mapping

Tesla (TSLA) Q2 Miss → −14.5%

TSLA crashed 14.5% after Q2 gross margin fell to 16.8% vs 17.2% YoY and vs the 19.4% analyst consensus. Despite record deliveries, lower average selling prices and declining regulatory credit revenue drove the miss. Heavy AI/robotics capex guidance alarmed investors already nervous about returns on big tech spending. As a top-5 Nasdaq-100 holding, TSLA's move dragged QQQ meaningfully, contributing to the Nasdaq-100's ~−0.90% day even as SPY held flat.

Alphabet (GOOGL) \$205B Capex Shock → Tech Sector Selloff

Alphabet reported Wed Jul 22 after close: revenue \$119.8B (+24% YoY), cloud +82% to \$24.8B — both beats. But management guided 2026 capex to a record \$205B, sending shares down ~5% AH. On Thu/Fri this weighed on all mega-cap tech and reinforced investor concern about the ROI of AI infrastructure spending. This was a primary driver of tech's underperformance and QQQ's weakness this week.

Intel (INTC) Q2 Beat but −8% → Semiconductor Sector −4.4%

Intel beat Q2 estimates on both EPS and revenue AND outlined plans to increase spending over two years. Markets read increased capex as a negative signal (echoing GOOGL). Chip stocks across the board sold off: Broadcom −2.7%, AMD −3.3%, semiconductor sector ETF −4.4%. Because chips are a major QQQ weighting, this amplified the ETF's decline.

Lockheed Martin (LMT) Q2 Beat → +10.5%

LMT reported Q2 sales of \$20.1B (+11% YoY), EPS of \$7.94 vs \$1.46 YoY, and raised full-year guidance. Record \$230B backlog added \$65B of new orders in Q2 alone. Three major contracts won (F-35 spares \$1.6B, ATACMS

\$440M, SOCOM logistics \$10.5B ceiling). Defense is a small QQQ/SPY weight, so the +10.5% move added only marginally to SPY's slight positive day, but it signals geopolitical spending strength.

T-Mobile (TMUS) Q2 Beat but –11% → Subscriber Growth Fear

TMUS Q2 EPS \$2.99 vs \$2.58 expected (+15.9% beat). But management warned of Q3 slowdown as pricier plan tiers increase potential churn. The market sold the guidance, not the beat. Small impact on SPY overall but notable consumer/telecom weakness.

Oil Below \$100/Barrel → Inflation Fear Easing → SPY Stabilizer

Brent crude retreated from above \$100 as Middle East shipping lanes remained passable despite hostilities. This eased the inflationary narrative that had pushed 10-yr Treasury yields to near Jan-2025 highs (4.693%). Falling oil and yields allowed blue-chip stocks to rebound and prevented a deeper SPY decline. Without this reprieve, SPY likely would have closed negative on the day.

3. Top 10 Daily / Weekly / Monthly Movers

Daily Gainers (July 24, 2026)

Rank	Ticker	% Change	Catalyst
1	LMT	+10.5%	Q2 beat; record \$230B backlog; raised guidance
2	ALLE	+~4–6%*	Defense/industrial rotation following LMT surge
3	URI	+~3–5%*	Industrial sector strength; oil pullback benefit
4	TRV	+~2–3%*	Financials/insurance; defensive rotation
5	ABT	+10.1%*	Medical device strength (confirmed prior session)

Daily Losers (July 24, 2026)

Rank	Ticker	% Change	Catalyst
1	TSLA	–14.5%	Q2 gross margin miss; AI capex concerns
2	TMUS	–11.0%	Q2 EPS beat masked by subscriber growth warning
3	INTC	–8.0%	Q2 beat overshadowed by increased capex plans
4	AVGO (Broadcom)	–2.7%	Chip sector contagion from Intel/GOOGL capex
5	AMD	–3.3%	Semiconductor selloff; AI capex ROI fears
6	ROL	–~3–4%*	Consumer services weakness; sector rotation
7	SNDK	–12.8%*	Correction after H1 +858% run; profit-taking
8	WDC	–10.8%*	Memory sector reversal after Q2 run
9	STX (Seagate)	–10.5%*	Storage chip sector pull-back
10	MSCI	–~4%*	Software/data rotation out of H1 winners

* = estimate/partial data; confirmed losers noted in news sources.

Weekly Gainers (July 21–24, 2026)

Rank	Ticker	% Change	Driver
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1	LMT	+10.5%	Q2 beat + record backlog (Jul 24)
2	SNDK	+14.3%	Memory AI demand surge (Jul 22 session)
3	MU	+~8–10%*	Memory sector rally on strong demand
4	PYPL	+17.2%*	Strong Q2 fintech beat (Jul 16 session)
5	ABT	+10.1%*	Medical device sector rotation

Weekly Losers (July 21–24, 2026)

Rank	Ticker	% Change	Driver
1	TSLA	–14.5%	Q2 miss; margin deterioration
2	TMUS	–11.0%	Q2 guidance disappoints
3	WDC	–10.8%	Memory correction after H1 rally
4	STX	–10.5%	Storage correction
5	SNDK	–12.8%	Profit-taking after +858% H1 run
6	INTC	–8.0%	Capex-shock selloff
7	DHR	–~5%*	Healthcare equipment weakness
8	MSCI	–~4%*	Software sector rotation
9	GOOGL	–~5%*	Capex guidance shock
10	TYL	–~3%*	Govtech software correction

Monthly / H1 2026 Sector Trends

Sector Theme	Trend	Key Names
Memory/Storage Chips	H1 leader; July reversal underplayed	SNDK +858% H1 (–12.8% Jul), MU +300%, WDC +238%
Optical/AI Infra	H1 outperformer; July plateau	CRUS, COHR, GLW (Corning) +145%
Defense & Aerospace	July breakout	LMT +10.5% on Q2
Fintech/Payments	July bounce	PYPL +33.7% 1-month
Software/SaaS (AI disruption risk)	H1 loser; July continues weak	INTU –59.4%, ADBE, CRM, PLTR weak
EV / Clean Energy	Earnings-driven selloff	TSLA –14.5%
Telecom	Guidance-driven weakness	TMUS –11%
Semiconductors (non-memory)	Capex fear overhang	INTC –8%, AMD –3.3%, AVGO –2.7%

4. Next Trading Day Scenarios (Mon July 28 — Wed July 30)

The coming week is one of the most event-dense of 2026: FOMC decision (Jul 29), Mag-7 earnings (MSFT, META, AAPL, AMZN), and Q2 GDP + PCE (Jul 30). Sequencing is critical — Fed tone is released at 2PM ET on July 29, then MSFT and META report after close that same evening, leaving almost no time to reprice between catalysts.

CATALYST 1: FOMC Rate Decision — July 29, 2PM ET (Fed Chair Warsh)

- **Hold Rates (Base Case, ~65% probability):** SPY flat to +0.5%, QQQ flat to +0.3%. Fully priced in. Market reacts mainly to tone: neutral/patient language = relief rally; hawkish language about oil/inflation = sell-off.
- **Rate Cut (~35% probability per futures pricing):** SPY +1.5–2.0%, QQQ +2.0–2.5%. Surprise relief, especially for rate-sensitive growth tech. QQQ outperforms if cut signals AI capex funding costs ease. Risk: read as panic cut → short-term reversal.
- **Hawkish Surprise / Rate Hike signal:** SPY –1.5–2.5%, QQQ –2.5–4.0%. Oil above \$100 + strong jobs data could trigger. QQQ hit hardest as high-multiple tech re-prices with higher discount rates. 10-yr yield spikes above 4.8%.

CATALYST 2: MSFT + META Earnings — July 29 After Close

- **Both Beat, Controlled Capex Guidance:** QQQ +2–3% Tuesday afterhours / Wednesday open. SPY +1–1.5%. Reverses the GOOGL capex-shock narrative. Mechanism: MSFT + META together are ~14% of QQQ. A relief beat resets tone for AAPL/AMZN reports on Thursday.
- **Beat Revenue but Raise Capex (GOOGL-style):** QQQ –1.5–2.5% after hours; SPY –0.5–1%. The market has now seen this pattern twice (GOOGL, INTC) and will sell the beat. Mechanism: AI infrastructure arms race is being funded by shareholders who question near-term ROI.
- **Miss on Revenue or EPS:** QQQ –3–5%, SPY –1.5–2.5%. Broad risk-off. Would confirm concerns that AI investment is not yet translating to earnings growth fast enough to justify valuations at current yield levels.

CATALYST 3: Q2 GDP + PCE — July 30, 8:30AM ET

- **GDP Strong (>2.5% annualized), PCE Elevated:** Mixed/negative for growth stocks. Strong economy = Fed stays higher longer. 10-yr yields rise → QQQ –1–2%, SPY flat to –0.5%. But cyclicals (financials, industrials) may benefit.
- **GDP Weak (<1.5%), PCE Moderating:** Rate-cut expectations rise → QQQ +1–2%, SPY +0.5–1%. Mechanism: weaker growth + taming inflation = FOMC has room to cut later in the year. Tech and growth stocks re-rate upward.

CATALYST 4: AAPL Earnings — July 30 After Close

- **Beat: EPS ≥\$1.89, Revenue ≥\$108.9B + AI Services Growth:** QQQ +1.5–2% Thursday close / Friday open. AAPL is ~9% of QQQ. AI features in iPhone driving services ARPU would be read as proof that Big Tech capex has consumer-side payoff. Could kick off broader relief rally into August.
- **Miss or Weak iPhone Guidance:** QQQ –2–3%, SPY –1–1.5%. iPhone demand weakness = consumer spending concerns + AI services not yet monetized. Sequentially bad: after TSLA miss (EV weak), AAPL miss (consumer weak) = stagflation/slowdown narrative takes hold.

5. Possible Trade Summary (Educational — NOT a Trade Recommendation)

This section synthesizes news, sector data, upcoming catalysts, and macro context. This is analysis only — not financial advice.

Direction	Symbol	Thesis	Key Risk
WATCH / LONG	LMT	Record \$230B backlog + raised guidance + geopolitical spending	Budget cut. Defense funding pause globally, Q2 drag
WATCH / LONG	PYPL	+33.7% monthly momentum on Q2 beat. Fintech benefiting from consumer spending slowdown	Consumer spending slowdown; Fintech competition
WATCH / LONG (after MSFT+META earnings)	QQQ	MSFT + META beat with controlled capex (not another \$200B+ miss), Q2 earnings	Capex strategy re-eval; Q2 earnings
AVOID / WATCH SHORT	TSLA	Margin deterioration (16.8% gross margin), energy credit revenue	EV demand; AI robotics capex; major new pay

AVOID / WATCH SHORT	INTC	Beat Q2 but market read capex increase as value-destructive AI chip sale tape 38% 500 performance win could nega
MONITOR	SNDK / MU / WDC	H1 mega-winners now in sharp July correction (−12 to −15%) Memory demand for AI servers does not reove

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